

Exhibit 2

Agricultural Conservation Easement Program – Wetland Reserve Easement (ACEP-WRE)

Areawide Market Analysis Proposed Illinois Geographic Rate Areas

Fiscal Year 2027

Background:

The ACEP-WRE is administered by the Natural Resources Conservation Service. Each state has the opportunity to establish geographical area rate caps (GARC's) which can be used as a least cost option (along with appraised value/market analysis or landowner offer) for determining the Agency offer for easement acquisition. Each state has the flexibility to consider local and regional factors for the GARC's as long as the rates are determined by credible and defensible means.

Options for Geographic Rate Areas:

In consultation with the State Technical Committee, it was decided that Illinois NRCS would use two eco-regional boundaries (modified to match County lines) to determine geographic rate caps. Illinois is split with the northern two thirds occupying the Central Com Belt Plains and the southern one third occupying the Interior River Valleys and Hills (as described by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency). The dividing line for the two regions is not distinct, but for the purpose of delineating the two regions we have established a line that runs from the north line of Crawford County west along the northern county lines of Jasper, Clay, Marion, Clinton and over to Randolph.

In addition to the two geographic areas following eco-region boundaries, a third area was designated by using the above-described methodology and applying it to an area consisting of counties affected by the highly populated Chicago metropolitan region where land use demands tend to drive up land prices.

Two land uses within the three geographic areas have been identified, cropland and non-cropland. Cropland is defined as:

1. Tillable, agricultural land capable of growing commodity crops,
2. Conservation Reserve Program land that has NOT developed to trees, pasture and hay land that is used for the grazing or removal of pasture products.

Non-cropland is defined as:

1. Existing wetlands,
2. Forested areas,
3. Conservation Reserve Program land that has developed to trees or
4. Other lands that are incapable of growing commodity crops.